

What would you be satisfied with by the end of this year?

A good-quality throw and a run-up that works. Over the last ten years, I've never set a distance as a target before any meet, and I'm not going to change that in 2025 either. For me, it's about maintaining good quality — both in training and in competition. I just want to see myself doing in competitions what I'm currently capable of in training. If I can do that, I'll be able to move forward confidently into the season.

You have won the Olympic title, the World title, and have the third-best throw of all time. Are there any goals left for you?

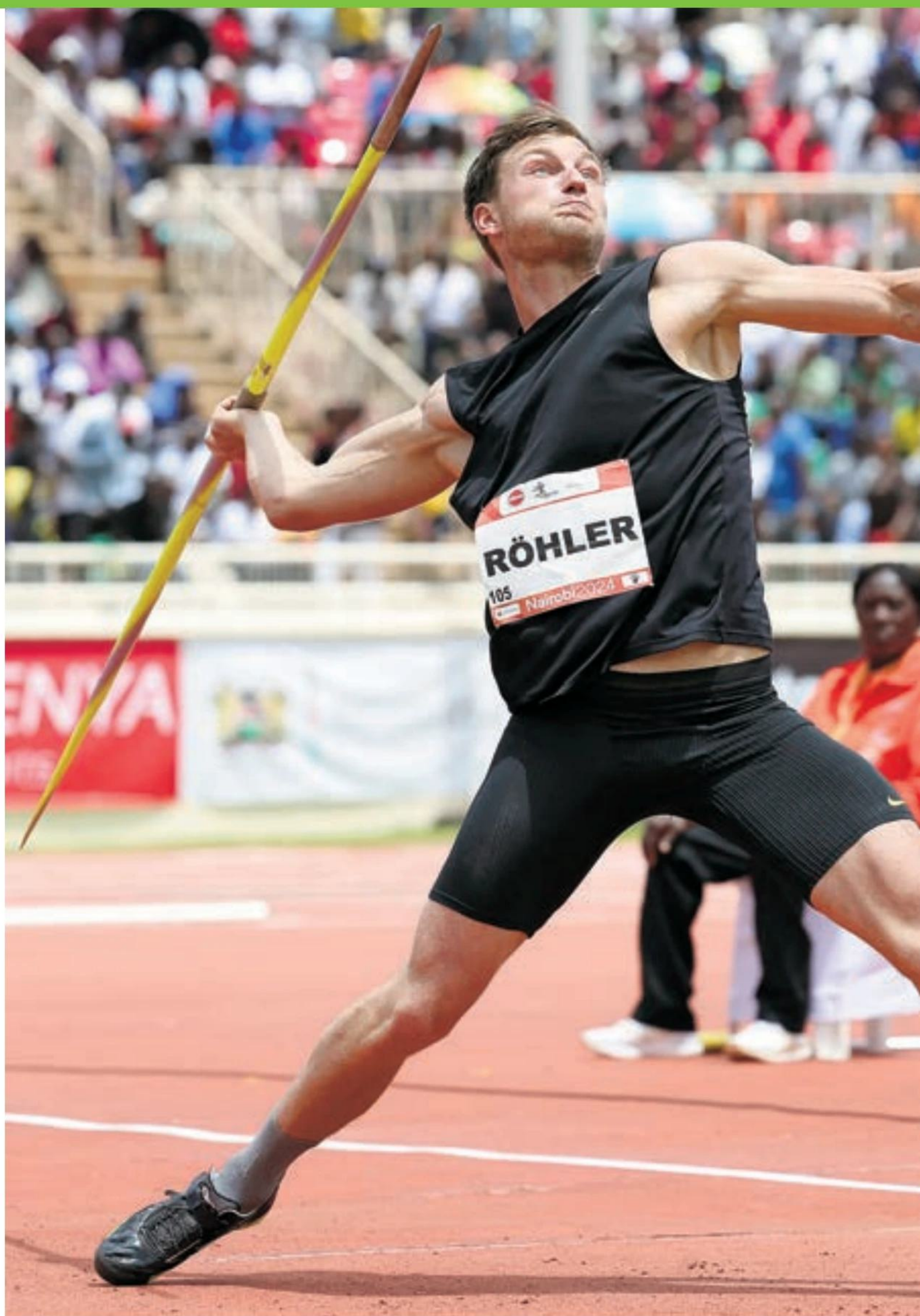
I actually started thinking about this question after I won my Olympic gold in 2016. Before those Games, I had told the German media that one day I wanted to throw over 90 metres and that I wanted to compete at the Olympics. I'd never really thought about winning gold — I just wanted to be an Olympian. That was what truly drove me into sport, and it's what still gives me goosebumps when I look back at my career.

And then came all these cherries on the cake. What I've come to realise is that what makes me genuinely happy is the lifestyle — and the fact that I love leaving footprints. The way I'm able to do that — not just for the next generation of athletes, but also, in a way, for myself — is by staying active in the sport.

So now, I just want to stay healthy and remain associated with the sport. If I can win another big title, that would be amazing. But there's no longer a sense of 'I have to'. I just want to enjoy it and be present.

You almost never made it to the Olympic final in 2016 — you qualified for the final only on your last throw in qualification. Could you take us through your Olympic experience?

2016 was one of the most challenging seasons of my whole career. Something most people don't know is that I injured myself really seriously at the European



Championships in Amsterdam, just a few weeks before the Olympics. I tore my latissimus (back) muscle, which is one of the bigger muscle groups. I was badly bruised all over my right side, and when I showed up for the MRI, they asked if I'd been in a motorcycle accident. I had to tell them I got it just by throwing a javelin.

Those six and a half weeks between that injury and the Olympics were among the most challenging phases of my career. Still, I knew I

was throwing well and had the best throw of the season (91.28m at the Paavo Nurmi Games in Turku). So at least on paper, and according to the data, I was ready to go for a medal in Rio — but given the condition of my body, I also knew it was going to be difficult.

That qualification round was actually a proving ground for me — a test of whether I was ready enough to attack hard. I was really pushing myself in the Olympic qualifier. I'm never a particularly good qualifier